ProduScope 2026 | E-Cell IIT Guwahati × StepSmart | FinLit Ventures case

AN EXPLAINABLE AI DECISION CO-PILOT

Before You Pause

Context, cost and control in the 3 seconds before an investor taps **Pause, Reduce or Stop** on a SIP. The investor always decides.

Context
Where you stand against your own goal

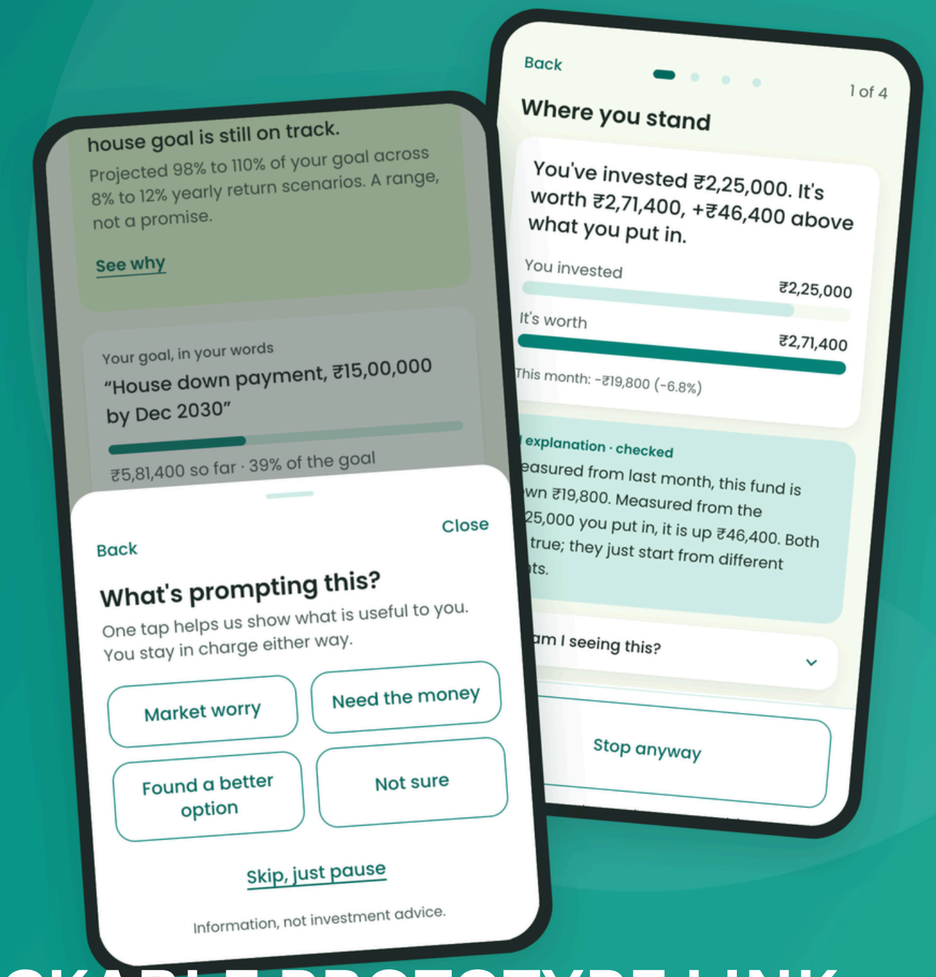
Cost
What the action changes, in rupees

Control
Three equal choices; one tap exits

81.1%
SIP stoppage ratio, Aug 2026 (53.82 L closed or matured vs 66.40 L new)

10.02 Cr
contributing SIP accounts, Aug 2026

₹32,297 Cr
record monthly SIP inflow, Aug 2026 (+14% YoY)



CLICKABLE PROTOTYPE LINK - DELIVERABLE 2

Live prototype screens: the reason question and the "where you stand" reframe

TEAM

Asymptotic

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Source for the figures: AMFI monthly SIP data, Aug 2026. "Before You Pause" is the working product name.

The Problem

What is the core problem?

Apps explain **last month** well, but stay silent in the 3 seconds before an investor taps **Pause, Reduce or Stop** on a SIP.

Fear of loss drives that tap: a loss weighs about **2.25×** an equal gain (Tversky & Kahneman, 1992), and a red monthly number becomes the reference point.

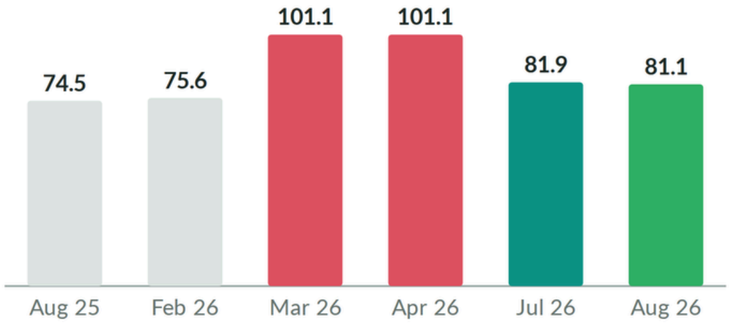
Alerts are **generic**. The same message reaches someone 4 years from a goal and someone 20 years away.

Pausing takes one tap, but the **cost of skipping** (the growth those instalments would have earned) is invisible.

Adding context without nagging or steering is hard. Trust is fragile and regulators expect AI that is **explainable** and leaves the call to the user.

SIPs are being stopped at scale

SIP stoppage ratio (closed or matured ÷ new SIPs, %)



Above 100% means more SIPs ended than started. The ratio includes SIPs that finished on schedule; AMFI does not split pauses or early exits.

10.02 Cr
contributing SIP accounts, Aug 2026

₹32,297 Cr
record monthly SIP inflow (+14% YoY)

81.1%
stoppage ratio: 53.82 L closed or matured vs 66.40 L new

Why this matters now

Scale
10 crore+ contributing SIP accounts: small changes in behaviour add up to large flows.

Nudges work
Zerodha reports penny-stock volumes on Kite fell by more than 50% after its Nudge launch (self-reported).

AI under watch
SEBI consulted on responsible AI/ML in Jun 2025; final guidelines announced as coming (Aug 2026).

Trust gap
SEBI survey barriers: complexity, lack of knowledge, trust deficits, fear of losses.

Investors want safety, yet many never start and some panic



of households are aware of at least one securities product



actually invest (about 3.2 crore households)



prefer capital preservation; 79% of Gen Z households are risk-averse

Source: SEBI Investor Survey 2025 (90,000+ households, ~400 cities, 1,000 villages).

What one panic tap costs (illustration)

Skip **3 instalments** of ₹5,000 = ₹15,000

→

≈ ₹22,137
by a goal date 51 months away, at an assumed 10% a year

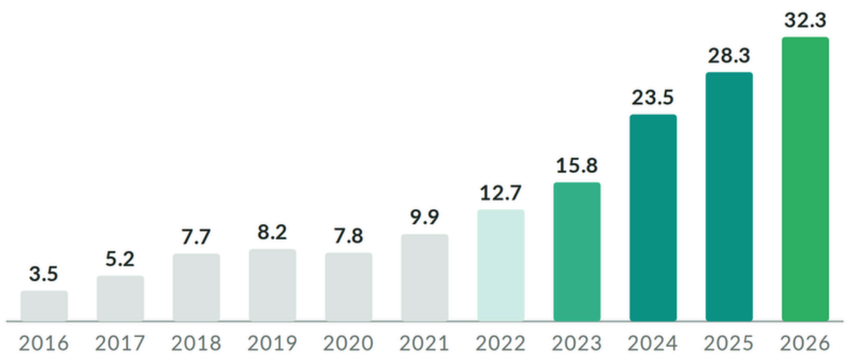
Who gets hurt: The Beginner · The Guardian · The Retiree. *Range ₹20,539 to ₹23,827 at 8 to 12%. Not a forecast.*

Sources: AMFI (Aug 2026), SEBI Investor Survey 2025, Tversky & Kahneman (1992), Zerodha 10-year post (self-reported), SEBI AI/ML consultation paper (Jun 2025).

Market Research

Market size and momentum (AMFI)

Monthly SIP inflow each August (₹ '000 crore)



₹87.08 L Cr
industry AUM (31 Aug 2026), about 6× in 10 years

28.35 Cr
investor accounts (folios)

6.14 Cr
unique investors (Mar 2026)

21.4%
of AUM sits in SIPs (₹18.62 L Cr)

Investor mindset (SEBI survey 2025)

63% of households aware of a securities product (about 21.3 crore)

9.5% actually invest (about 3.2 crore households)

22% of aware non-investors plan to invest within a year

Urban 15% vs **rural 6%** participation

Mutual funds: **53%** aware, **6.7%** invest

Barriers: **complexity · lack of knowledge · trust deficits · fear of losses**

Competitive benchmarking

Platform	At tap?	What it does today
Zerodha (Kite Nudge)	—	Pre-trade warnings on penny and illiquid stocks. Not goal-linked; not built for SIPs.
Kuvera (CRED)	—	Apr 2026 behavioural framework scores discipline, allocation, performance. After the fact.
Groww · ET Money · INDmoney	✗	Dashboards and X-ray analytics; a SIP change is handled as a plain transaction.*
Before You Pause	✓	Goal-aware, explainable sheet at Pause, Reduce and Stop. The investor decides.

*Amber = partial: warns, but not goal-aware. *Per public product pages; flow screenshots being captured.*

Opportunity sizing

₹694 Cr
TAM per month

₹208 Cr
SAM per month

₹46.4 Cr
SOM per year (Month 18)

TAM: 53.82 L closures × 40% premature (A1) = 21.53 L early exits × ₹3,224 average ticket (₹32,297 Cr ÷ 10.02 Cr accounts). SAM: × 30% on integrable digital surfaces (A2). SOM: 5,00,000 accounts (A3) × 12% attempt a change a year (A5) × 20% kept on Continue (A4) × ₹3,224 × 12.

Sensitivity: TAM ₹347 to ₹1,041 Cr/month (A1 = 20 to 60%); SOM ₹23.2 to ₹69.6 Cr/year (A4 = 10 to 30%).

Tailwinds

- **Ageing India:** 60+ share 10.5% (2022) to 20.8% (2050), 149 M to 347 M people (UNFPA)
- **SEBI responsible AI/ML:** consultation Jun 2025; final guidelines announced as coming
- **DPDP Act and dark-pattern guidelines (2023)** set rules for consent and design

Positioning and moat

Zerodha proves a well-timed nudge works; Kuvera proves demand for behavioural insight. **Nobody joins timing and personal goals at the SIP-pause tap.**

- Decision-outcome dataset (reason, choice, 90-day result)
- Goal-linked SIP graph
- Compliance as a product: rules engine + audit log
- Tuned Hindi and regional phrasing

Sources: AMFI (Aug 2026 data, SIP table, folios), AMFI Factbook 2026, SEBI Investor Survey 2025, UNFPA India Ageing Report 2023, Zerodha, Financial Express (Kuvera). Sizing assumptions A1 to A5 are ours.

User Persona / User Research

The Beginner

Name: *Arjun*
Age: *20*
Location: *Tier-2 city (hostel)*
Occupation: *3rd-year B.Tech student*

About ₹12,000 a month (pocket money plus tutoring). ₹1,000 SIP in an index fund, 9 months in. Learns from reels and friends; one red number can make him quit.

Goals
- Build a **₹30,000 first-job cushion** by graduation
- Learn how investing works without feeling lost
- Stay consistent on a tiny budget

Pain points
- Jargon: "what does a 5% dip even mean?"
- Cash swings (fees, hostel costs) push him to pause
- Peer noise: "stop your SIP, markets are crashing"

What we offer
- Plain-language reframe + "How this is calculated" [MVP]
- Reason router, cash path, Reduce-instead [MVP]
- Goal link [MVP]; Timeline + Plan Memo, Hindi [P1]

Success: SIP still contributing at 90 days; comprehension rate

The Guardian

Name: *Rajesh*
Age: *45*
Location: *Indore*
Occupation: *Accounts manager, family provider*

About ₹1.2 lakh a month take-home; ₹32,000 home-loan EMI. ₹25,000 a month in SIPs across 4 funds, ₹22 lakh linked to goals.

Goals
- **₹30 lakh** for his daughter's education in 24 months
- Protect the capital he has built
- Keep a 6-month emergency buffer

Pain points
- Fears capital loss: every call is high-stakes
- Distrusts black boxes and sales incentives
- Cash shocks (EMI, fees) force pauses; no record of why

What we offer
- Goal cost card, 3 scenarios + "what could go the other way" [MVP]
- Explain panel: sources, freshness, formula [MVP]
- Timeline, scheduled pause [P1]; redemption flow [P2]

Success: Goal on track after the decision; regret rate no higher than control

The Retiree

Name: *Meena*
Age: *58*
Location: *Lucknow*
Occupation: *Vice-principal, govt. school (retires in 2 yrs)*

About ₹85,000 a month; gratuity and PF due at retirement. ₹10,000 SIP in a conservative hybrid fund; ₹18 lakh in funds. Checks daily when markets fall.

Goals
- Build a **₹22 lakh retirement buffer** in 26 months
- Protect it from big drops
- Stay in control without asking family each time

Pain points
- Once sold in a sharp fall and regretted it
- Jargon and small print
- Fear of scams and of losing control

What we offer
- Rupee-based reframe, no red alarm; large text [MVP]
- "Nothing changes until you confirm"; Score wording "assumptions still hold" [MVP]
- Hindi [P1]; redemption [P2]; calm check, opt-in [P3]

Success: Regret rate; SIP and goal continuity

What the research says

~80%
of households prefer capital preservation to high returns

79%
of Gen Z households are risk-averse

63% → 9.5%
aware vs invest; barriers: complexity, trust, fear of losses

10.5% → 20.8%
share of Indians aged 60+, 2022 to 2050 (UNFPA)

Research plan (planned, not yet run)

- 15 interviews (5 per persona) and a 200-person survey
- Test H1 to H4: cash need vs market worry split; goal-linked vs generic nudges; wish to see sources; plain words and Hindi
- Kano questions added to the survey to validate feature categories
- Personas are illustrative composites; figures are sample data

Sources: SEBI Investor Survey 2025, UNFPA India Ageing Report 2023. [MVP] months 1 to 3, [P1] months 4 to 6, [P2] months 7 to 12, [P3] months 13 to 18 of the roadmap.

User Journey

	1 Discover	2 Onboard	3 Autopilot	4 Trigger	5 Intervention	6 Decision	7 Goal reached
Arjun The Beginner, 20 *Goal: ₹30,000 cushion by Month 29*	6	8	7	3	5	7	9
	Campus finance-club session. A friend shares a recap card: "I reviewed my plan before changing my SIP".	Day 1 to 2: KYC, picks an index fund, **₹1,000 SIP**. Goal set. Three consents shown separately.	Months 1 to 8: instalments debit quietly, no alarms. 9 done = **₹9,000** invested.	Month 9: fund down **₹530 (5.2%)** to ₹9,600. Friends say "stop SIPs". He taps Pause for 2 instalments.	Picks "market worry". Still **₹600 above** invested. Skipping ₹2,000 is worth ≈ ₹2,317 at 10%; goal about 2 months later. History line omitted: fund too new.	Reduces to **₹500 for 2 months**. Logged in his Timeline. 90-day check-in: no regret.	Month 29: projected **₹31,059 / ₹31,685 / ₹32,315** at 8 / 10 / 12%, above ₹30,000.
Rajesh The Guardian, 45 *Goal: ₹30 lakh for daughter's education, Month 24*	5	6	7	3	5	7	8
	His investing platform rolls out the co-pilot. An in-app note explains what it does and never does.	Day 1 to 3: grants each consent, links ₹25,000 of SIPs to the goal. Comfort level: a fall of up to **10%**.	Months 1 to 2: quiet. No banners over his dashboard.	Month 3: linked funds down **₹1,40,000 (6.0%)** to ₹22,00,000. A delayed bonus makes him want a 3-month pause.	Sees "You said you could sit through a fall of up to 10%; this month's dip is 6.0%." Skipping ₹75,000 ≈ **₹87,219** at 10%. Checks the sources.	Reduces to **₹12,500 for 3 months** (₹37,500 skipped ≈ ₹43,609). SIP returns to ₹25,000 after.	Month 24: projected **₹30,35,016 / ₹31,24,768 / ₹32,15,660**, all above ₹30 lakh.
Meena The Retiree, 58 *Goal: ₹22 lakh buffer by retirement, Month 26*	4	6	5	2	4	7	8
	Her daughter recommends it. Her bank's relationship manager mentions it at the annual review.	Day 1 to 5: set up on a video call, large text (Hindi in P1). Comfort level: a fall of up to **5%**.	Month 1: quiet.	Month 2: hybrid fund down **₹38,000 (3.2%)** to ₹11,50,000. She taps Stop SIP "to be safe".	Still **₹1,30,000 above** invested. By retirement: ₹20,41,605 (93% of goal) if she stops vs ₹22,96,703 (104%) if she continues, at 6.5%.	Chooses a **3-month pause** with a reminder (₹30,000 skipped ≈ ₹33,672). Resumes at 90 days; no regret.	Month 26: buffer projected at **103%** (₹22,63,032). Later, the P2 redemption flow adds exit-load and tax context.

Dots: hypothesised mood score (1 to 10); red = low point. Illustrative composite personas, sample figures. Returns at assumed rates (8 / 10 / 12%; 6.5% for Meena's hybrid fund), not forecasts.

Vision, Value Proposition & Business Goals

VISION

Make the moment before every irreversible money action the best-informed moment of an investor's financial life.

VALUE PROPOSITION

"Before you pause, see what you'd be pausing. Your goal, your horizon, and what it costs, in your own numbers."

Context
Where you stand against your own plan. Every number traces to a disclosed input, source and date.

Cost
What the action changes, in rupees, under three labelled return scenarios. Deterministic maths, never LLM output.

Control
Three equal-weight choices and a one-tap exit on every panel. Nothing changes until the investor confirms.

Business goal	Product response	Evidence of success
Fewer impulsive stops Avoid poorly contextualised decisions during volatility.	**Intervene at the tap** Fires only on explicit intent (sip_action_selected). Never on the dashboard or headlines.	**Avoidance lift** ≥ +8 pp SIPs contributing at day 90 vs holdout; regret no higher than holdout.
Higher goal awareness Make goal, horizon and risk relevant to this decision.	**Show the effect on their own goal** Goal-linked cost card, 3 return scenarios and the goal-date shift.	**Comprehension** CDR ≥55% (North Star); "How this is calculated" opens ≥20%.
Trust in explainable AI Reasoning the investor can inspect.	**Calculate first, then explain** The engine computes, the LLM only phrases, a validator gates every caption.	**Trust and reliability** Helpful rating ≥70%; validator fallback <3% of captions.
Decision-time support Move FinLit from hindsight to the moment of action.	**One question, then context** About 30 s of optional context; one-tap Skip; 14-day cooldown.	**Usable, safe intervention** Skip rate ≤35%; p95 sheet <400 ms; cash-path drop-off watched.

Trade-offs we chose deliberately

Retention vs user interest
Risk: A continuation target can reward trapping someone who needs the money.

Our choice: North Star is comprehension, not retention. "Need the money" gets a neutral path with no loss framing.

Intervention vs friction
Risk: An extra screen can feel like a block.

Our choice: One question; Skip on every panel; Pause never hidden or delayed; 14-day cooldown.

Personalisation vs explainability
Risk: A personal AI answer can hide its reasoning or invent numbers.

Our choice: Deterministic engine; LLM fills placeholders only; validator fails closed to a fixed template.

Personalisation vs privacy
Risk: Tracking can collect more than the decision needs.

Our choice: v1 uses only the reason chip, language and stated setup answers. No emotion inference; consent per purpose.

Inform, never instruct | **Show the cost of action and of inaction** | **The LLM never calculates** | **One tap always exits**

All targets are pilot hypotheses, not observed results. Who wins: investors (a calmer, explainable moment), FinLit and partners (trust, fewer regretted exits, an audit trail), regulators and AMCs (human-governed AI).

Solution Overview & Decision Flow

1 Tap
Investor taps Manage, then **Pause this month**, **Reduce amount** or **Stop SIP**. Event: sip_action_selected.

2 Eligibility gate
Kill switch on · no planned pause · no session on this SIP in 14 days · consent · ≥2 instalments · fresh payload · treatment arm.

3 One question
"What's prompting this?" Four chips, plus **Skip, just pause** in one tap.

4 Context by reason
Panels routed by the answer (below). Every number from the engine; AI text validated.

5 Three equal choices
Skip this month · Reduce for a while, then auto-restore · Pause. Nothing changes until confirm.

6 Confirm and learn
Confirmation, Decisions Timeline, optional recall tap, 90-day check-in.

Fail open for the investor: if any gate check fails, or the engine is slow (BFF timeout 800 ms) or down, the existing SIP flow runs unchanged. The co-pilot never blocks an action.

Step 4 · the answer decides the context (reason router)

Need the money
Cash path

Neutral options only: skip the next instalment, reduce to ₹2,500 for 3 months, or pause 3 months with a reminder. No loss framing, no persuasion.

Market worry
Reframe → cost → score

"Where you stand": −₹19,800 this month but +₹46,400 above what was put in. Cost card (1 to 6 months, 8 / 10 / 12%) and Confidence Score.

Found a better option
Facts, not picks

Category, expense ratio, overlap with his other fund, instalments and value, then the cost card. "We do not recommend or rank funds."

Not sure
Full flow

Reframe, cost card and Confidence Score with "How this is calculated", sources and data date.

Behind the screen: the engine calculates, AI only explains

Nightly engine
Python computes every number after NAVs publish

Template
Deterministic text renders in <400 ms

LLM caption
Phrases {{placeholders}}; accepted only within 1.5 s

Validator
Slot-fill, numeric grounding, language lint

Serve + log
AI text if valid, else the fixed template; audit log

✓ PASSES · served
LLM: "Your fund is down {{dip_amount_inr}} this month…" → renders "down ₹19,800"; every number matches the payload.

✗ FAILS · template shown
"You should keep going. Your fund fell ₹25,000." → banned phrase + ungrounded number.

Fail closed for AI text: late, invalid or advice-like captions are replaced by pre-approved templates; failures are logged. **No free text** from the investor reaches the prompt in v1 (the reason is an enum), so the prompt-injection surface is minimal.

Behavioural design

Prospect Theory: move the reference point from "last month" (a loss of ₹19,800) to "entry price and goal" (still ₹46,400 above invested). Show the cost of acting and the risk of waiting with equal weight, in neutral colour.

Fogg B = M × A × P: motivation (fear) is acknowledged, not fought; ability stays one tap; the prompt is goal-anchored ("This SIP funds your House Down Payment").

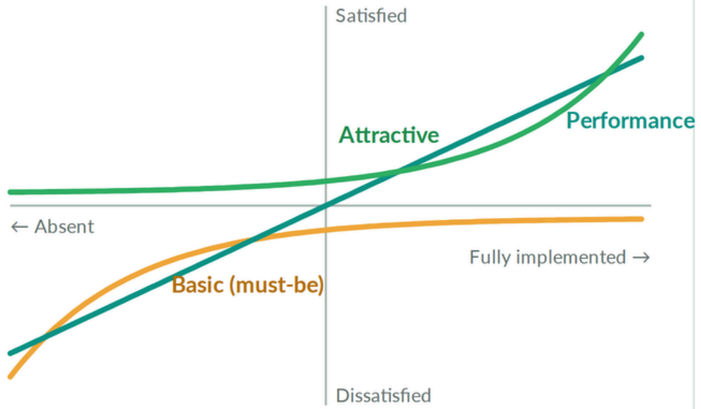
We never use: fear copy, red alarms, countdowns, confirm-shaming, "others are holding" pressure, hidden pause, return predictions or auto-execution.

FIXED LINE, INJECTED BY THE SYSTEM (NEVER AI-WRITTEN)
"What could go the other way: if markets keep falling, your holding can lose more value before it recovers. Continuing does not protect against loss."

Cash-path amounts shown for the sample ₹5,000 SIP; pause lengths depend on the fund house. Information, not investment advice.

Key Features & Kano Analysis

Kano map (hypotheses, not survey findings)



- **Basic:** F1 sheet with one-tap Skip · F3 explainability
- **Performance:** F4 reason router · F2 cost card · F5 Reduce-instead · F7 scheduled pause
- **Attractive:** F6 Plan Memo · F8 Timeline + check-in · opt-in calm check (P3)
- **Reverse risk:** F9 open-ended AI chat (Won't build now)

How Kano and RICE work together

Basic · secure first. Trust, accurate numbers and an easy exit are non-negotiable, whatever the score.

Performance · sequence by RICE. More relevant context and clearer consequences raise satisfaction as they improve.

Attractive · validate next. Plan Memo, Timeline and the calm check ship only if the survey confirms the delight.

Validate with paired Kano questions in the 200-person survey, by cash need vs market worry. Must-be / MoSCoW Must.

Feature suite F1 to F9 · what each solves and how we expect users to perceive it

ID	Feature	User problem	What it does	Phase	Kano hypothesis
F1	**Pre-decision sheet + trigger engine**	The costly tap happens with zero context.	Bottom sheet on sip_action_selected after the gate; one-tap Skip on every panel.	MVP	BASIC Control without friction
F4	**Reason router**	Why the investor wants to stop is unknown.	"What's prompting this?" routes the flow; cash need gets a neutral path.	MVP	PERFORMANCE More relevant context
F2	**Goal-linked cost card**	Today's loss hides the long-term cost.	Slider 1 to 6 months; Pause / Reduce / Stop; 8 / 10 / 12%; goal-date shift; "what could go the other way".	MVP	PERFORMANCE Clearer consequences
F3	**Confidence Score + explain panel**	AI feels like a black box.	Score 0 to 100 with a published formula; sources, freshness, "How this is calculated", "Not used".	MVP	BASIC Inspectable rationale
F5	**Reduce-instead**	Pause vs continue feels binary.	Lower the SIP for 1, 3 or 6 months (above the fund minimum), then auto-restore.	MVP	PERFORMANCE Useful middle path
F6	**Plan Memo at SIP setup**	The original "why" is forgotten.	The investor's own written goal, replayed at the pause moment.	P1	ATTRACTIVE Validate before scaling
F7	**Scheduled pause + reminder**	A pause quietly becomes a stop.	Pause for N months with a reminder date.	P1	PERFORMANCE Continuity
F8	**Decisions Timeline + 90-day check-in**	No record of why a decision was made.	Log of decisions; check-in asks how it went (feeds the regret metric).	P1	ATTRACTIVE Validate before scaling
–	**Opt-in "calm check"**	Anxiety builds between taps.	Volatility-aware check-in, opt-in only; test with and without it.	P3	ATTRACTIVE Candidate delighter
F9	**Open-ended AI chat**	Unconstrained output, compliance risk.	Free-text chatbot.	Won't	REVERSE RISK Not built now

Choices offered at the decision: offer once, then respect the choice

Skip one instalment
Resumes next month automatically

Reduce for 1, 3 or 6 months
Auto-restores to the original amount

Pause
Until restarted; P1 adds a reminder date

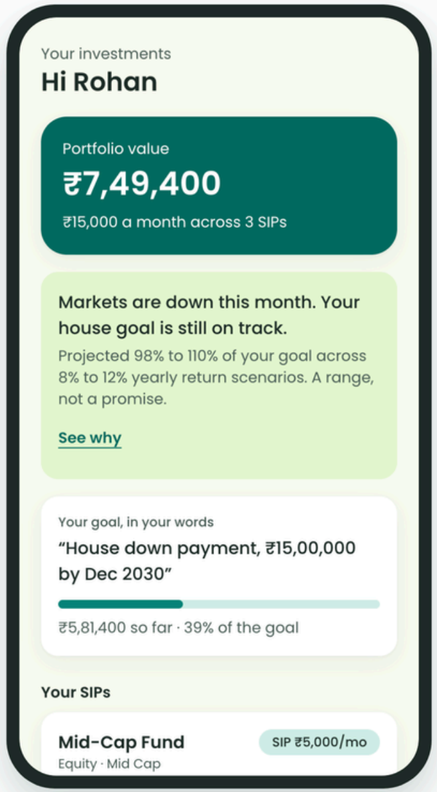
Stop
Money already invested stays invested

Won't ever build: auto-execution of any transaction · fund or product recommendations · predicted returns · "others are holding" social proof · blocking or delaying the pause.

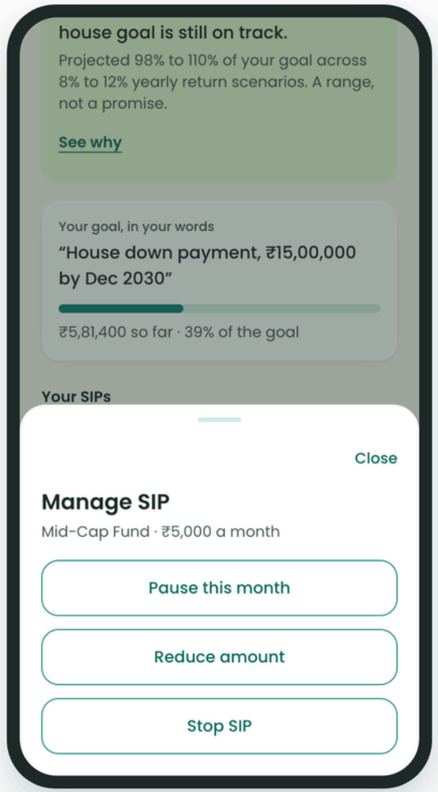
Kano model reference: ASQ. Feature IDs match the RICE table on slide 11. Kano categories are team hypotheses to be validated with users.

Prototype Walkthrough 1: Trigger to Reframe

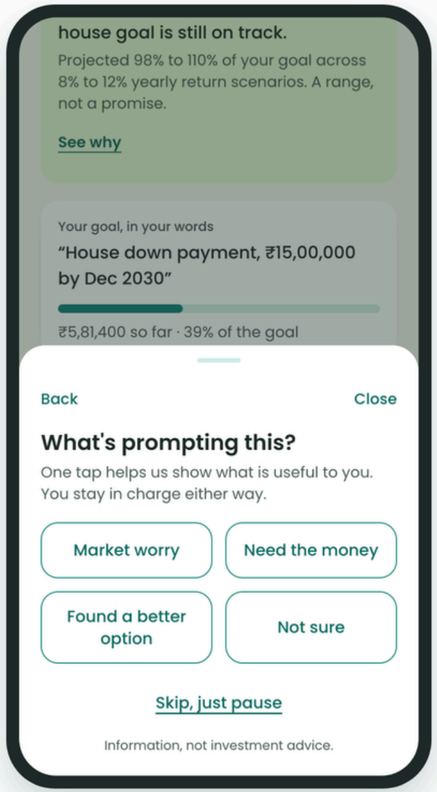
1 · Home



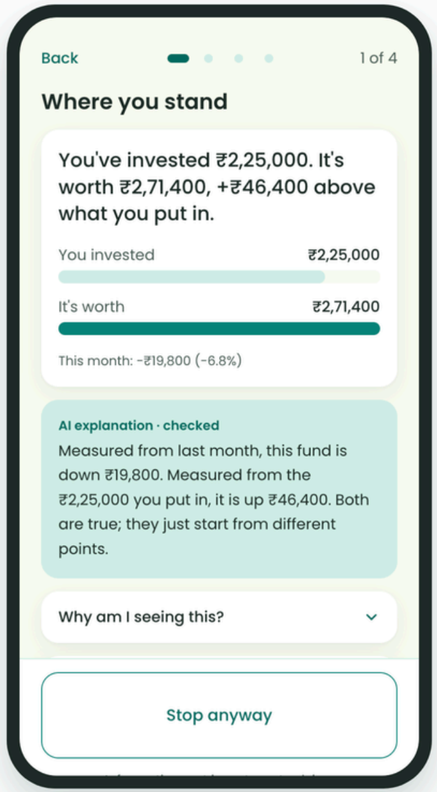
2 · Trigger



3 · Intervention



4 · Intervention



Goal first, alarm never

- Market dip shown beside the investor's own goal: "still on track", **a range, not a promise**
- Goal in their own words: ₹5,81,400 so far, 39% of ₹15,00,000
- No red banners while the investor is only checking

The exact trigger

- **Pause this month**, **Reduce amount** or **Stop SIP** fires sip_action_selected
- The co-pilot appears only on explicit intent and only after the eligibility gate
- If the engine is down, this existing flow simply continues

One question, never a wall

- "What's prompting this?" with four chips routes the flow
- **Skip, just pause** is one tap; Close is always there
- "Need the money" gets the neutral cash path: no loss framing

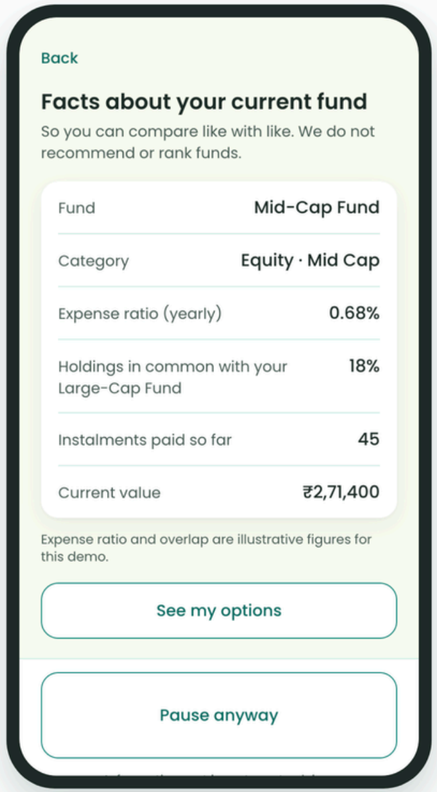
Reframe the reference point

- Down ₹19,800 from last month, yet **+₹46,400** above the ₹2,25,000 put in
- Engine numbers; AI text labelled "checked"; "Why am I seeing this?" opens the method
- **Stop anyway** stays visible on every panel

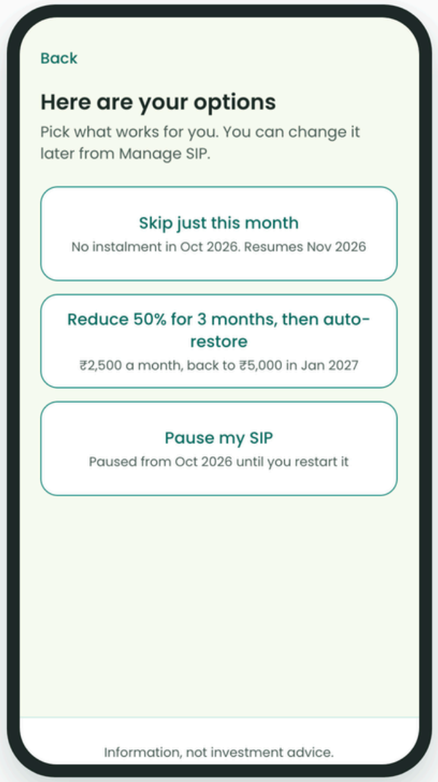
Live prototype screens, trimmed to the app view. Demo account Rohan, 29 (sample data): Mid-Cap Fund SIP ₹5,000 a month, goal ₹15,00,000 by Dec 2030.

Prototype Walkthrough 2: Options, Decision & Recall

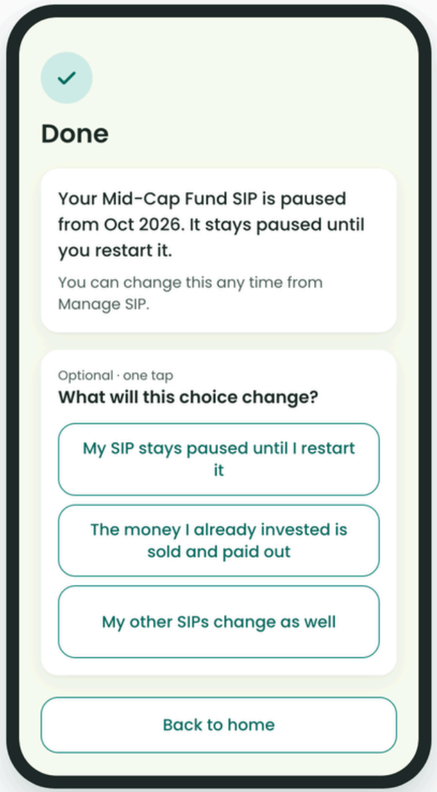
5 · Better-option path



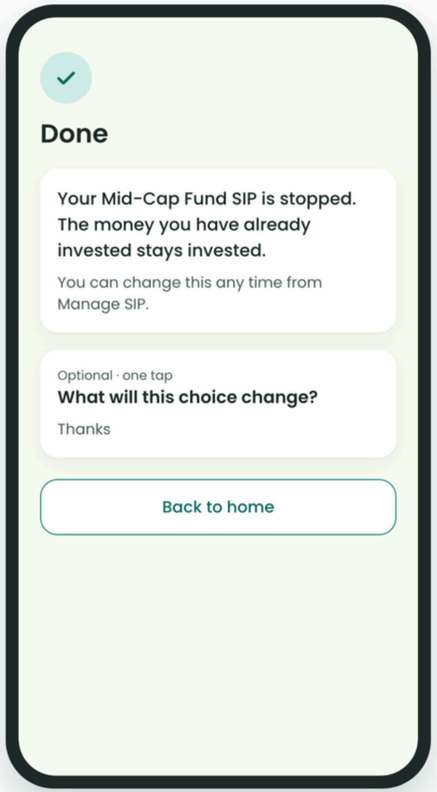
6 · Decision



7 · Confirmation



8 · Confirmation



Facts, not picks

- Expense ratio, overlap with his Large-Cap Fund, instalments and value
- "We do not recommend or rank funds": stays on the decision-support side
- **Pause anyway** is one tap

Equal-weight middle paths

- Skip just this month (resumes Nov 2026)
- Reduce 50% for 3 months: ₹2,500, back to ₹5,000 in Jan 2027
- Pause until restarted. Same size, no default highlighted; changeable later

Recall tap powers the North Star

- Plain confirmation of exactly what changed
- Optional "What will this choice change?" One answer matches the engine outcome
- A correct answer plus panel dwell counts toward CDR

Stopping is respected

- "The money you have already invested stays invested"
- Reversible any time from Manage SIP
- Logged to the audit trail; 90-day check-in feeds the regret metric

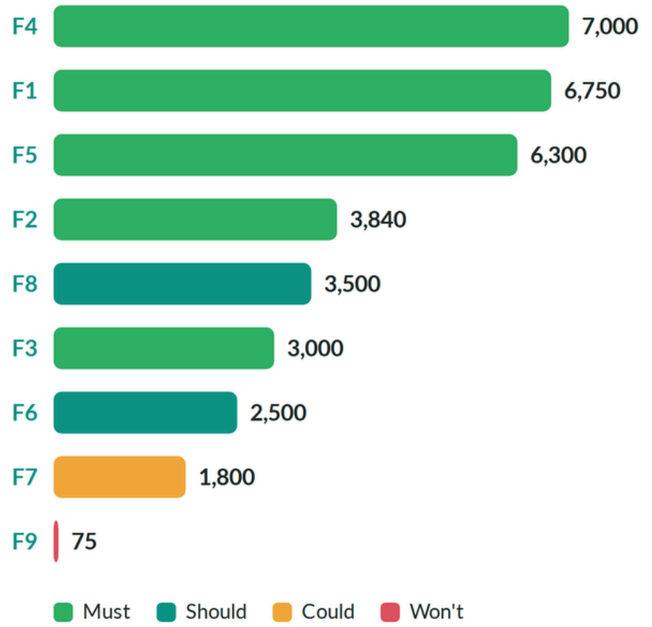
Live prototype screens, trimmed to the app view. Expense ratio and overlap are illustrative demo figures. Information, not investment advice.

Feature Prioritisation: RICE & MoSCoW

RICE = Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort

#	ID	Feature	Reach / qtr	Impact	Conf.	Effort (p-wk)	RICE	MoSCoW	Phase
1	F4	Reason router	15,000	2	70%	3	7,000	Must	MVP
2	F1	Interstitial + trigger engine	15,000	3	90%	6	6,750	Must	MVP
3	F5	Reduce-instead	9,000	2	70%	2	6,300	Must	MVP
4	F2	Goal-linked cost card	12,000	2	80%	5	3,840	Must	MVP
5	F8	Decisions Timeline + check-in	15,000	1	70%	3	3,500	Should	P1
6	F3	Score + explainability panel	15,000	1	80%	4	3,000	Must	MVP
7	F6	Plan Memo	30,000	0.5	50%	3	2,500	Should	P1
8	F7	Scheduled pause	6,000	1	60%	2	1,800	Could	P1
9	F9	Open-ended AI chat	3,000	0.5	40%	8	75	Won't	Not now

RICE score by feature



Discipline calls: rules override scores when they protect the user

F3 is a Must despite ranking 6th

Disclosure and explainability are regulatory expectations for financial AI, so the Score and explain panel ship in the MVP.

F9 scores 75 and is refused

Open-ended chat means unconstrained output and the highest compliance risk for the lowest reach.

MVP = 5 Musts, 20 person-weeks

F4 + F1 + F5 + F2 + F3 (3 + 6 + 2 + 5 + 4). Should and Could items follow in P1 once the pilot gate is met.

How we scored

- **Reach** = 5,00,000 protected accounts × 3% attempting a change per quarter (A5) = **15,000 intent events a quarter**; F6 uses 30,000 new SIP setups a quarter (A6)
- **Impact** scored 0.25 to 3; **Effort** in person-weeks; **Confidence** reflects evidence today
- **Won't, ever:** auto-execution, fund or product recommendations, predicted returns

RICE inputs are team estimates at Month-18 scale, not validated demand. Phases: MVP months 1 to 3, P1 months 4 to 6.

Roadmap, Go-to-Market & Monetisation

M1 M2 M3 | M4 M5 M6 | M7 M8 M9 M10 M11 M12 | M13 M14 M15 M16 M17 M18

MVP (P0) · Foundation and pilot

- Trigger engine + eligibility gate
- Reason router, cash path
- Reframe, cost card, Score panels
- Reduce-instead
- Audit log + kill switch
- Engine v1; 50/50 experiment

Gate: CDR ≥50%, skip ≤40%, fallback <3%, zero compliance incidents

P1 · Personalisation v1

- Reason-aware thresholds
- Decisions Timeline + 90-day check-in
- Plan Memo
- Scheduled pause + reminder
- Hindi + one regional language
- 90/10 holdout

Gate: Positive avoidance lift; regret not above holdout

P2 · Extend the moment

- Redemption and withdrawal flows with exit-load and tax-impact calculators
- Partner SDK and API (build from M7)
- Compliance dashboard
- Audited outcomes report

Gate: Two partners live; audited outcomes report published

P3 · Scale

- Portfolio-exit flow; ETF analytics
- Account Aggregator ingestion
- Learned threshold tuning (human-approved)
- Opt-in volatility-aware calm check

Gate: 5,00,000 protected accounts; SEBI final AI guidelines mapped

GO-TO-MARKET

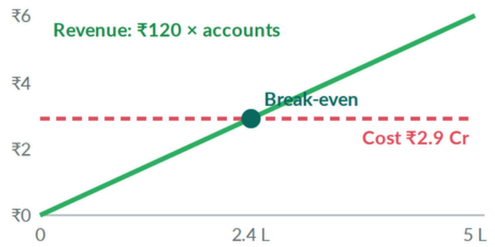
Stage 1 · Pilot
50,000 FinLit SIP accounts, randomised 50/50

Stage 2 · Prove
1,00,000 FinLit accounts, 90/10 holdout; partner LOIs signed

Stage 3 · Partner scale
5,00,000 protected accounts: 2 partners by M12; 5 partners + 1 AMC by M18

Monetisation and unit economics

- **Free to investors.** Partners pay a flat **₹10 per protected account per month** (₹120 a year), never tied to retained assets
- Month-18 run-rate: 5,00,000 × ₹120 = **₹6.0 Cr**
- Cost base: 6.5 FTE × ₹25 L = ₹1.625 Cr + ₹1.3 Cr infra, LLM, legal = **₹2.9 Cr a year**
- Break-even ≈ **2,41,667 accounts**, reached in P3



Annual ₹ Cr vs protected accounts

Value delivered (base case): about ₹46 Cr a year of SIP flow kept on Continue. It does not enter the fee.

Channels and beachhead

- **Beachhead:** salaried investors aged 25 to 35 in metros with a goal-linked SIP that has lived through a drawdown
- **In-app:** FinLit's own app is the pilot surface, at zero acquisition cost
- **B2B SDK and API** for distributors and RIAs
- **"Decision Audit Pack"** for partner risk and compliance teams

Team (6.5 FTE)

1 PM · 3 full-stack engineers · 1 quant / data engineer · 1 designer · 0.5 compliance lead

Adoption loops

Trust loop
Informed decision → 90-day recap → optional share card (no figures) → referrals

Data loop
Reason chips and outcomes → better thresholds and phrasing

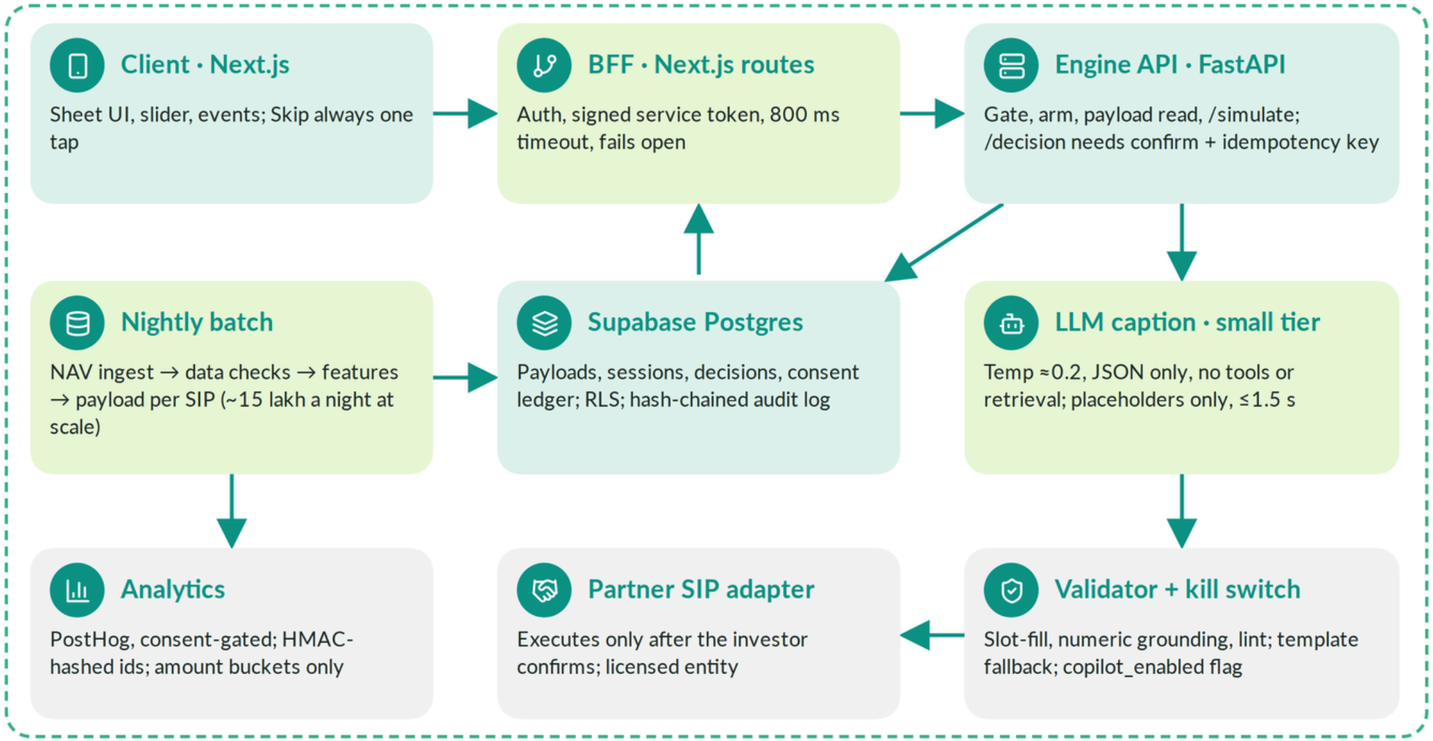
Partner loop
Audited outcomes report → more partners → stronger benchmarks

Why it scales: trigger, computation and guardrail layers are decoupled from any one decision. Redemption needs a new calculator and payload schema; audit, validator and consent layers are reused.

Rollout, pricing and cost base are planning assumptions (A3, A8, A9, A10) to be validated in the pilot and partner pilots.

Technical Architecture & AI Reasoning

System architecture and data flow (batch-first: NAVs publish once a day)



AI reasoning framework: four separated jobs

Engine computes
skipped_fv = Σ per_month × $(1+r)^{h-1-k}$, r = $(1+a)^{1/12}$ − 1. Rohan, 3 × ₹5,000 over 51 months: ₹20,539 / ₹22,137 / ₹23,827.

LLM phrases
Receives fixed-schema slots, returns text with {{placeholders}}. Never types a digit, recommends, predicts or executes.

Validator gates
Unknown slot, ungrounded number or banned phrase ("you should", "guaranteed", "will recover", Hindi "chahiye") → template.

Policy decides
Eligibility, cooldown, arm. Personalisation = reason chip, language, stated setup answers only; no emotion inference.

Change control: every prompt, template, threshold or banned-list change is a new version, signed off by a named compliance owner, shadow-tested, and reversible in minutes via the kill switch. Golden set of ~200 payloads (English + Hindi) must pass 100%.

Latency budget

Payload read	Sheet visible	BFF → engine	AI caption
p95 <300 ms	<400 ms	800 ms timeout	≤1.5 s, no retries

Contextual Confidence Score (CCS)

CCS = 0.35 × Goal coverage + 0.25 × Horizon buffer + 0.20 × Diversification + 0.20 × Drawdown context



81/100
"Your plan's core assumptions still hold"

Bands: 75 to 100 hold · 50 to 74 shifted · 0 to 49 changed materially. Describes how well the investor's own setup assumptions hold; **not a prediction, fund rating or recommendation.**

Known limit: diversification counts funds, so one broad index fund scores low. Revise before launch.

Failure behaviour: fail open for the user, closed for AI text

Event	What the investor sees
Engine slow (>800 ms) or down	**Existing SIP flow runs**
LLM late (>1.5 s) or errors	**Template stays**
Validator fails or is down	**Template; reasons logged**
Stale or failed NAV job	**No payload; co-pilot hidden**
Consent withdrawn mid-session	**Generic sheet**
Reason = need cash	**Fixed cash-path copy, no LLM**

Stack is a design proposal; engine, validator and tests run and pass; SQL and API are a spec not yet run on a live database. CCS example uses sample data.

North Star, Metrics & Experimentation

NORTH STAR

Comprehended Decision Rate

≥55% pilot target

Attempts with **≥4 s on ≥2 context panels** AND a **correct recall answer** ÷ attempts that reached a decision and answered recall.

Why not retention? A retention metric rewards trapping people; CDR rewards understanding. **An informed pause counts as a win.**

If fewer than 40% answer the recall tap, CDR is flagged unreliable.

Instrumentation

copilot_triggered · reason_selected · panel_viewed (dwell_ms) · slider_moved · why_expanded · skipped · caption_served · choice_made · recall_answered · feedback_given · checkin_response · sip_resumed · killswitch_fallback

Identity = HMAC-SHA256 of user id; client analytics start only after consent; no PII or exact amounts.

Common properties: session_id, variant, prompt_version, engine_version, language, sip_amount_bucket (<2k, 2k to 5k, 5k to 10k, 10k+), scheme_category.

Source of truth: decisions, panel views, captions and check-ins live in Postgres; PostHog is for funnels.

Metric tree (all targets are pilot hypotheses)

Branch	Metric	Formula	Target
Outcome	**Avoidance lift**	P(SIP contributing at day 90 | treated) − holdout	≥ +8 pp
Outcome	**Regret rate**	Restart / raise within 90 days, or reported regret ÷ pausers	≤ holdout
Understanding	**CDR (North Star)**	As defined at left	≥55%
Understanding	**Score expansion**	"How this is calculated" opens ÷ sessions	≥20%
Trust	**Skip rate**	Sessions skipped at any panel ÷ sessions	≤35%
Trust	**Helpful rating**	Thumbs-up ÷ ratings	≥70%
Safety	**Validator fallback**	Template fallbacks ÷ captions	<3%
Safety	**p95 sheet latency**	Tap to sheet visible	<400 ms
Safety	**Complaints**	Co-pilot tickets ÷ sessions × 1,000	< baseline

Dark-pattern alarm

If retention rises while regret among retained users also rises, the intervention is coercing users: **treat it as a failure, stop and review.**

Phase gates: MVP needs CDR ≥50%, skip ≤40%, fallback <3% and zero compliance incidents; P1 needs positive avoidance lift with regret no higher than holdout.

Experiment design

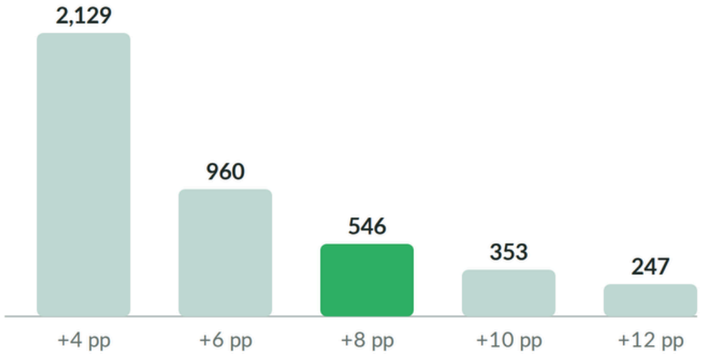
Months 1 to 3
Pilot: 50,000 accounts, randomised **50 / 50** treatment vs holdout

Months 4 to 9
90 / 10 with a permanent 10% holdout

Deterministic hash assignment (salt + experiment + user id); abandoned attempts recorded as "keep" in both arms.

Sample size to detect avoidance lift

n per arm = $(1.96 + 0.84)^2 \times (p_1q_1 + p_2q_2) \div \Delta^2$, baseline 30% contributing at day 90



Attempts needed per arm, by lift to detect

+8 pp (30% → 38%) needs 546 attempts per arm. 50,000 accounts × 3% a quarter = 1,500 attempts a quarter → about 2.2 months to enrol 1,092, plus 90 days to observe.

CDR and safety	First lift readout	Lift and regret
Weekly	≈ Month 5	Day 90

Targets are pilot hypotheses, not forecasts or observed results. Sample size at 95% confidence and 80% power.

Guardrails, Risks & Assumptions

Decision support, not advice

We do

- ✓ Show facts about the investor's own SIP, goal and horizon
- ✓ Compute the cost of an action under labelled scenarios
- ✓ Offer equal-weight options, including the original one
- ✓ Log every payload, caption and choice

We never do

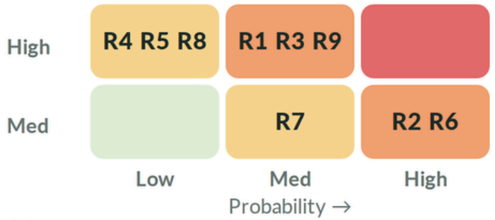
- ✗ Say "you should" or "we recommend"
- ✗ Predict returns or promise recovery
- ✗ Suggest a fund, a switch or a product
- ✗ Pause, change or execute anything without a confirm tap

Language lint (EN + Hindi) · **AI disclosure + sources** · **Human sign-off + shadow tests** · **Immutable audit log** · **Dark-pattern rules (CCPA 2023)** · **DPDP: 3 separate consents**

Before launch: open legal items

- Counsel to confirm the licence perimeter under SEBI (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013, incl. whether goal projections count as financial planning
- Run as a technology layer inside a licensed RIA, distributor or AMC flow
- Disclosures for illustrations and recovery history (D4, D5); audit retention; cross-border LLM processing
- Map to SEBI's final AI/ML guidelines when published

Risk matrix



Highest-impact risks (advice classification, harm to a cash-needy user, conflict of interest) each have a code-level control and an early-warning metric reviewed weekly in the pilot.

#	Risk	Mitigation	Early warning
R1	**Output read as advice**	Lint; no advice; counsel sign-off; kill switch	Lint blocks
R2	**Interstitial fatigue**	Cooldown; reason routing; one-tap Skip	Skip rate >35%
R3	**Friction hurts a cash-needy user**	Neutral cash path, no loss framing	Cash-path drop-off
R4	**LLM states an unsupported figure**	Validator + template fallback	Fallback >3%
R5	**Stale or wrong NAV data**	Data checks block bad payloads	Payload freshness
R6	**Incumbent copies the UI**	Outcome data, goal graph, audit layer	Partner win rate
R7	**Metric gaming**	Dwell + recall; regret cross-check	CDR vs regret gap
R8	**Privacy breach**	RLS, encryption, DPDP consent ledger	Access anomalies
R9	**Conflict of interest**	Flat fee; publish outcomes	Regret vs holdout

Assumptions register

ID	Assumption	Test
A1	40% of closures are premature	Pilot exit reasons
A2	30% of exits on integrable surfaces	Partner data
A3	5,00,000 accounts by M18	Partner pipeline
A4	20% of attempts kept on Continue	Holdout test
A5	3% attempt a change a quarter	Pilot telemetry
A6	30,000 new SIP setups a quarter	Product analytics
A7	60-month reference horizon	Compliance review
A8	Rollout 50k / 1L / 5L accounts	Partner commitments
A9	₹10 / account / month accepted	Partner pilots
A10	₹2.9 Cr annual cost base	Budget review

Next 30 days

- Run 15 interviews and the 200-person survey (H1 to H4 + Kano)
- Capture competitor pause-flow screenshots
- Legal opinion on the perimeter; name a compliance owner

THE ASK

Inform, never instruct. Show the cost both ways. The investor decides.

A 3-month, 50,000-account randomised pilot inside FinLit's app proves comprehension first, then avoidance lift with no rise in regret.

≥55%	+8 pp	≈M5	2.42 L
CDR target	avoidance lift	first readout	break-even accounts

Not legal advice: a design position pending counsel. Each assumption A1 to A10 has a test in the pilot. Personas and demo data are illustrative.